

Durably Sustainability Scan

Methodology note - EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825 and EU Forced Labour Regulation lens

The Sustainability Scan is a claims-risk screening tool. It does not attempt to rate a company's overall ESG performance. It identifies external sustainability wording that may be problematic because it is generic, absolute, insufficiently evidenced, consumer-facing under EmpCo, linked to supplier or forced-labour assurance, or contradicted by negative external stakeholder signals.

1. Scope of the scan

The scan reviews sustainability wording in websites and uploaded company documents. It separates green claim signals and social claim signals. The tool retains only material problematic claim passages. Neutral statements, headings, navigation labels, general sustainability-report context, and ordinary references to suppliers or communities are not retained unless they imply a specific sustainability benefit, assurance, control, full coverage, certification, traceability, due diligence or legal/regulatory compliance.

Included in claim review	Normally excluded from claim review
Generic environmental claims such as eco-friendly, green product, sustainable products, planet friendly, carbon neutral, fully recyclable, zero impact.	Sustainability report, sustainability strategy, corporate governance headings, neutral menu labels.
Supplier or social claims implying control or assurance: responsible sourcing, ethical sourcing, traceable suppliers, all suppliers audited, forced-labour free.	Neutral references such as working with suppliers, backing British suppliers, supporting local suppliers, supplier portal.
Visual signals where available in HTML metadata: eco badge, green leaf, planet icon, recycled badge, sustainability badge.	Decorative or generic images where no environmental or social meaning can be inferred from text, alt text, title, class, file name or surrounding wording.

2. Regulatory lenses used

Lens	What the scan checks	Examples of retained signals
EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825	Consumer-facing environmental claims are checked for generic wording, absolute wording, climate-neutrality / offsetting wording, future environmental-performance claims, comparison claims, labels and legal requirements presented as green benefits.	eco-friendly packaging; sustainable products; carbon neutral product; net zero product; green certified; 100% recyclable; greener than alternatives.
Green Claims Directive proposal as best-practice lens	Although legislative status may change, the scan uses its substantiation logic as good practice: objective evidence, high-quality data, scope, methodology, limitations and verifiability.	Claims lacking scope, data period, methodology, source evidence or same-medium specification.
EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015	Product, import/export, supplier, traceability and forced-labour wording is checked for possible overstatement of assurance.	forced-labour free; no child labour; fully traceable supply chain; all suppliers comply; responsible sourcing without coverage evidence.
OECD Guidelines, UNGPs, ILO, CSRD/ESRS	Social claims are checked against due diligence, affected stakeholders, grievance/remedy, worker voice, supply-chain coverage and measurable evidence.	human rights across our value chain; living wage across supply chain; zero discrimination; fully inclusive workplace.

3. Claim materiality gate

A phrase is not retained simply because it contains a sustainability-related keyword. The scan applies a materiality gate before a finding is displayed. The wording must either match a direct EmpCo-sensitive pattern, imply a specific environmental or social benefit, imply product/supplier assurance, or create a high evidence burden. The report therefore focuses on passages that may require legal, compliance, marketing or sustainability review before external use.

Question	Materiality test
Is this merely context?	If the wording is only a heading, navigation label, report title or neutral corporate context, it is not retained.
Does the wording imply a sustainability benefit?	If yes, the scan checks whether the benefit is generic, absolute, comparative, future-oriented or evidence-heavy.
Does the wording imply assurance or control?	Supplier and social wording is retained only where it suggests coverage, certification, auditing, traceability, compliance, due diligence or rights protection.
Could an average consumer or stakeholder be misled?	Higher attention is given to consumer-facing marketing claims, product claims, packaging claims and public campaign wording.

4. Score calculation

The scan produces three separate scores: Green score, Social score and Global score. Scores are risk indicators, not legal findings. They are calibrated to avoid overstating isolated wording signals. A single problematic phrase normally results in a limited to medium concern unless it is a direct blacklisted-practice indicator, lacks substantiation and/or is supported by negative external stakeholder signals.

Component	Weight / role	What it measures
Material claim wording	Core driver	Severity of retained claim passages: generic environmental wording, climate-neutrality, labels, absolute claims, forced-labour assurance, supplier assurance, human-rights assurance. Multiple material findings increase the score gradually.
Evidence-gap risk	Major modifier	Whether the scanned material contains scope, data, baseline, methodology, reporting period, limitations, certification/verification and review owner. Lack of evidence raises the score.
Negative external stakeholder context	Major modifier	Only retained negative stakeholder signals are used: regulator actions, court cases, NGO/union concerns, complaints, investigations, critical media or enforcement. Company-owned documents and positive/neutral news are excluded.
Sector and channel sensitivity	Baseline modifier	Sectors with complex supply chains, high consumer exposure, retail/product claims or high labour-risk exposure receive a higher baseline sensitivity. Consumer-facing channels receive more EmpCo weight than internal or investor-only documents.

Interpretation bands

Score band	Interpretation
0-24	No material problematic claim retained or only limited residual context risk.
25-44	Low to moderate claim-quality concern. Review wording and evidence before reuse.
45-64	Material claim-risk signal. Wording, evidence and source context should be reviewed by sustainability, marketing and legal/compliance teams.
65-79	High claim-risk signal. Usually requires multiple findings, regulatory relevance, weak substantiation or external stakeholder concern.
80-100	Very high claim-risk signal. Reserved for stronger combinations of severe wording, weak evidence and negative external stakeholder context.

5. How the Green score is calculated

The Green score is driven by material environmental claims retained under the EmpCo lens. The highest sensitivity is assigned to generic environmental claims, product-level carbon or climate neutrality claims, self-declared sustainability labels, legal requirements presented as environmental benefits, absolute environmental terms and unsupported comparisons. The score is not a count of keywords; it reflects the quality and risk profile of exact claim passages.

Green claim module	Risk rationale
Generic environmental claims	Terms such as eco-friendly, green, sustainable product, natural or planet friendly can be problematic if they are not clearly specified and substantiated.
Climate / offsetting claims	Claims such as carbon neutral, climate neutral or climate compensated are high sensitivity, especially at product level or when based on offsets.
Labels and icons	Self-declared labels, badges or visual cues may imply independent verification or broad environmental performance.
Future and comparative claims	Net-zero ambitions and better-than comparisons require implementation plans, methods, comparators and update mechanisms.

6. How the Social score is calculated

The Social score focuses on problematic social claims, not on all social wording. Supplier, worker or community references are retained only where the wording implies assurance, broad coverage, certification, audit, traceability, due diligence, human-rights protection, forced-labour controls or guaranteed outcomes. Neutral wording such as backing British suppliers is not treated as a problematic claim unless the same passage includes assurance or control wording.

Social claim module	Risk rationale
Forced-labour / modern-slavery claims	Claims implying that products, suppliers or supply chains are free from forced labour require product/supplier traceability, risk assessment, mitigation, remediation and withdrawal-response readiness.
Supplier-responsibility claims	Responsible sourcing, ethical sourcing, traceable suppliers and all-supplier coverage claims require scope, supplier-tier coverage, method, findings and corrective-action evidence.
Human-rights and labour claims	Broad statements about human rights, living wage, decent work or zero discrimination require due diligence, grievance channels, stakeholder coverage and remedy evidence.
Absolute workplace / inclusion claims	Zero harm, guaranteed equal opportunities and similar absolute claims create a high evidence burden.

7. External stakeholder signals

The external-source layer is intentionally narrow. It is designed to test whether retained claims may be contradicted or challenged by negative stakeholder perceptions. It excludes company-owned policies, sustainability reports, supplier codes, corporate press releases, positive partnerships, awards and neutral corporate news. Those documents can be useful evidence, but they are not negative external stakeholder signals.

Retained	Excluded
Regulator actions, court cases, complaints, investigations, NGO or union concerns, critical media, enforcement actions, allegations or stakeholder criticism.	Company sustainability reports, annual reports, supplier codes, policy PDFs, corporate websites, awards, partnerships, product launches, positive news and neutral business updates.

8. Outputs and limitations

The scan provides an executive summary, three scores, retained material claim signals, red flags by green/social dimension, negative external stakeholder signals where available, suggested improvements and a compact company report. It is an indicative first-pass screening tool and does not provide legal advice. All findings should be verified by legal, compliance, sustainability and marketing specialists before publication or enforcement conclusions are drawn.

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